FT FollowThrough

The Landscaping Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- Weekly mowing, a one-time cleanup, or a new install like beds or mulch?
- How big is the yard, and is there a back lawn, a slope or a gate?
- How tall is the grass right now?
- What's the address? I'll look it up on the map before I come.

> "Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me about the yard and I'll see how we can help."

> "I can come by for a quick look Monday after 4 or Tuesday morning, or quote from photos today. Which works better?"

2. Presenting the quote

- Write down what each visit includes: mow, trim, edge, blow off the drive.
- Give the price per visit and the season total, and say how rain days and skipped weeks work.
- Add a one-time catch-up fee if the grass is over 6 inches.
- For installs, list the plants, mulch and labor, and offer two or three options.

> "Here's what each visit includes, here's the price, and your day would be [day]. I can start this week. What questions do you have?"

3. The 7 objections landscapers hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. "The other guy charges less per cut."
"That's fair, I'd compare too. Does his price include edging, trimming and blowing off the drive, and is he insured if a rock breaks a window? That's where prices differ. I'll put exactly what each visit includes in writing so you can compare line by line."

2. "I want to get a few more quotes."
"Makes sense. Which matters most to you: price, a set day or clean edges every time? When you compare, check how often they come, what a visit includes, how they handle rain days and whether they're insured. I'll check back Friday in case anything's unclear."

3. "Can you do it for less?"
"I can, by changing the plan. What budget did you have in mind? Every-other-week mowing or skipping edging on the back lawn brings it down. I won't rush the cut, because scalping the grass costs you more to fix later."

4. "My neighbor's kid will do it for $25."
"That can work, and I'd never knock a kid earning money. What happens when they're away or it rains for a week in May? I'm insured, I come on a set day and I text before each visit. Want me to do one cut so you can compare?"

5. “Let’s wait until the lawn really needs it.”
“Understood. How tall is it now? In spring grass can grow an inch or more a week, and a lawn that gets ahead of you needs a catch-up cut that costs more. I can start every other week and switch to weekly when it takes off.”

6. “The last guy just stopped showing up.”
“That’s frustrating, and it happens a lot. What day of the week works best for you? I put your day in writing, text before every visit and send a photo when I’m done. If rain pushes me back, you hear it from me first.”

7. “Why do you want a card on file?”
“Fair question. Would you rather not deal with checks? You’re billed once a month for visits already done, and every charge comes with an emailed invoice listing the dates. I’ll send you a sample invoice first so you can see it.”

4. Follow up: day 2, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful.

> **Day 2:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Did the quote come through okay? Happy to answer any questions.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], I’m already mowing on your street on [day]s, so I have a spot for you. Want me to start this week?”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday so I can plan my routes. If you’d still like to go ahead, reply and I’ll hold your day.”

In spring, people book whoever gets back to them first. Reply to new requests the same day.

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask after the first few visits, when the yard looks its best, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Thanks for having us, [Name]. If you’re happy with the yard, would you leave a quick Google review? I’ll text you the link. And if a neighbor needs help, I’d be glad to add them to my route.”

Neighbors are your best customers: one more stop on the same street costs you almost no drive time. Offer them a price for joining your route.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Don’t spray weed killer without an applicator license, and never put flyers in mailboxes. Both bring fines.
- Add equipment cover and lock the trailer. General liability doesn’t pay for your own stolen mower.
- Put the visit, rain days and 30 days’ notice to cancel in writing, and save part of every summer payment for winter.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for landscapers: followthroughguides.com/landscaping · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com